

- **Improved support metrics:** Increased rates of self-service and ticket deflection mean one thing: an improvement in the support team's goals and metrics. Conversational AI is what a support team needs to help increase customer satisfaction by reducing response times.

E-commerce: According to *Forbes*, more than 2 billion people made online purchases in 2020 and 2021, and e-retail sales totalled US\$ 4.2 trillion globally. With such massive volumes, there is clearly a significant opportunity to utilise conversational AI for e-commerce businesses. Here are a few examples.

- **Automated purchasing:** Conversational AI can help customers automatically make purchases online, set up automated repeat orders, and deal with any issues regarding their purchases.
- **Insightful data:** AI isn't just helpful for the people using it; it can actually give very insightful data for businesses as a whole. By taking in data every single day, AI can help you learn about customer buying habits, get feedback, and help you strategise.
- **Boost customer satisfaction metrics like NPS and CSAT:** The best customer insights come after their interactions. With AI you can access data, analyse it using customer metrics and use it to improve business operations across the board.

Banking and financial services:

Conversational AI is being used to reduce friction and make banking easy for customers to manage on their own. Besides automating functions and conversations, AI has helped reduce operating costs.

- **Account management:** Conversational AI or a banking virtual assistant can check customer balances and process transactions across all bank accounts, help make transfers, freeze accounts, or increase limits with the help of artificial intelligence.
- **Analysis of data:** Businesses can learn a lot from customers' banking

habits, using the information to push initiatives and create goals that will improve customer experience.

Education: Education is one of the top industries benefiting from automated interactions and artificial intelligence. With Covid-19 moving learning online and institutions going through digital transformations to keep up with the times, it's clear that there is an opportunity to change things within education and leverage AI.

Conversational AI has shown that the education industry is on track to make learning more personalised, accessible, feasible, streamlined, and instant. This is what AI is doing for education.

- **Artificial teaching assistants:** AI can help with personalised learning by providing individual artificial teaching assistants that learn about the student and can adapt to their study habits with them.
- **Boost performance:** AI can help figure out where students can perform better.
- **Set learning pace:** Everyone learns at their own pace. If students are following an online learning course, AI can help set the pace for their personalised learning.

Retail: According to a recent IBM study, the adoption of AI in retail and consumer products is expected to grow another 40 per cent in the next three years.

Here are a few examples of conversational AI implementation in retail.

- **Searches:** AI can help you get the most up-to-date information regarding prices and deals. Machine learning algorithms now show you personalised information based on past retail searches.
- **Order management:** Intelligent chatbots have come a long way. They can now be used to manage shopping orders, tracking order status with a bot that can automatically find the information you need.
- **Account management:** Chatbots can also help with account management.

There's no need for human interference when AI can reset passwords and set up two-factor authentication for customers.

Insurance: Insurance is finally undergoing a digital transformation and it's using AI to help it. Here are a few examples.

- **Assessing risk:** With the emergence of machine learning algorithms, it's become even easier for underwriters and insurance agents to bring in more information and data in order to gauge the risk being taken by insurance companies.
- **Fraud detection:** Insurance is complicated; it is not uncommon for people to lie on insurance applications to try to get better premiums or better coverage. AI can help detect fraud by having accuracy parameters set on applications in order to ensure that information being sent in is accurate and truthful.
- **Reducing human error:** The chain between a person and their insurance policy is wide and complex; there is a series of middlemen who examine information between the insured and the carrier. A lot of information can get lost due to human error and manual work. Conversational AI can reduce human error by analysing documents and data for you, minimising the friction and possibility for mistakes.

Travel: With conversational AI, the travel industry has reached new heights.

- **Booking:** AI can help travellers book their flights! Chatbots can be deployed to help travellers find the best deals and secure them.
- **Skychannel bots:** If a friend or loved one is travelling, you can scan the sky for their flight using AI tools that tell you exactly where the flight is currently. Now let's briefly explore the conversational AI services being offered by the tech giants.